Mapping The Intimate Body 2

Developing Personal Practices for Intimacy coaches

Sunday, June 16th 2024
with Cyndi Darnell

AGENDA

Inviting pleasure through laughter

waking up the pelvis

language of sex

PLISSIT

Q & A

Self in Practice

Your Practice Turn Triads

Closing

LAUGH

WAKING UP THE PELVIS

USING OUR WORDS

Be Here Now

Erotic Horny Arousal Asshole
Cock Orgasm Sexy Succulent
Sweet Lubricate Hard Pussy
Cream Ejaculate Penis Fuck
Loose Wet

Be Here Now

Be attentive to how these words make you feel.

You using? Clients using?

If using only clinical words *all the time*, what effect might that have on bringing *sex* into the coaching space?

The PLISSIT Model

PLISSIT – A Model for Sexual Inquiry

- Developed in the mid-1970s and still used today, Jack Annon's PLISSIT model is a tool for both assessing and managing a client's sexuality concerns. PLISSIT is an acronym for the following:
- Permission
- Limited Information
- Specific Suggestions
- Intensive
- Therapy

Permission

- Permission – normalizing – sex-positive – emphasises worthiness
- Sexual dreams, fantasies, feelings, thoughts & experiences - facilitates curiosity
- Many people (esp cis-women and NB) feel their experience (internally) is abnormal. Cause of pain, guilt and shame.
- Normalizing in many cases reduces anxiety guilt & shame
- Prioritizes erotic wellbeing

Limited Information

- Sex in our culture-built upon myths and incorrect information.
- Reconceptualizes misperception and replaces myths with factual or best-known information / alternative perspectives.
- Information focuses on client / patients specific situation.
- In many scenarios information provides relief.

Specific Suggestions

- Specific Suggestions: Attempts to help the client replace one behaviour / thought /experience with another – ideally more useful / effective.
- E.g. – seeking the location of pleasure, reframing unhelpful /intrusive thoughts, struggles and difficulties

Intensive Therapy

- In more severe cases:
- e.g. sexual / body image problems,
- prolonged issues
- past / unresolved relationship problems
- past trauma
- Clients may also be referred when sexual / erotic / relationship counselling is beyond the knowledge or comfort level of the practitioner (e.g. to fertility specialists, sexuality counselors / therapists, menopause practitioners).

Traps

Where we can lose sight of the big picture

Assumptions & Judgements

- practices
- orientation
- partner(s) / relationship status
- age differences
- gender expression & identity
- ethnicity /race
- cultural /religious differences
- sexual history
- drugs & other substances

Transference & Counter-Transference

- triggers
- Transference - clients projecting ideas, values, beliefs, hopes and expectations onto us, often without explicitly acknowledging them
- Counter Transference - our responses to these unspoken projections with projections of our own
- making room for emotions
- mentoring & case supervision

QUESTIONS

Self In Practice

How Do I Show Up Around Sex?

- How do I show up in sex with myself?
- How do I show up in sex with my partners?
- How do I notice when my fears, boundaries, longings, sensitivities show up in sessions?

Consider patterns, beliefs, hopes, fears, expectations, motivations, strengths

BREAKOUT SESSIONS